Next Up — Features & test checklist

Oct 15, 2026 · @Vicky

Next Up replaces the pickup whiteboards: players join with a code and their name and get a buzz when they're up, and the organizer runs the whole line from one screen. Below is what each role can do, what has already been tested, and a checklist to run at a practice session before using it for real.

Player features

Players never make an account: a code and a name is all it takes.

Joining

- Join with the event's 4-digit code or custom password, then your name.
- Scan the organizer's QR code or open a shared link to skip typing the code.
- If a friend or the organizer already put your name down, you're asked "Is that you?" before taking that spot.
- Rejoining on the same phone goes straight back to your board.
- Names are unique per event. Signed out or switched phones? Join with the same name and answer "Is that you?" to get your spot back; the phone already signed in gets a heads-up.

Getting it on your phone

- A "Get it as an app first" card on the join screens (phones only).
- One-tap Add to Home Screen on Android; a step-by-step help page for iPhone, Android and computers.
- A move code (6 letters, single use, 30 minutes) carries your name and game spots from the browser into the Home Screen app.

The board

- Live view of the game on the field (timer, teams, pinnies) and every board in the line, with no refreshing.
- Status card: playing now, up next, or your place in line with a time estimate.

- Event code bar: tap it to share the join link with friends.
- Last call banner when the organizer stops adding boards.
- The event's color scheme, set by the organizer.

Signing up

- Put your name down on any board with space; teams fill evenly, or you pick your team if the organizer allows it.
- You can't sign up twice for the same game, and you're held to the event's sign-ups-per-person limit.
- Take your name off a game that hasn't started (if the organizer allows it).

Friends

- Add friends by name to any board with room, on Team 1, Team 2 or either.
- Switch a friend's team or take them off while their game is waiting; only you can change friends you added.
- Your friends' alerts come to your phone ("For Jo: You're up next!"), and a line on your board shows where your friends are.

Alerts

- Turn alerts on or off from the bar at the top; off stays off.
- Notifications for: signed in, up next, get ready (heads-up before the current game ends), you're on, your game started (with your team and whether to grab a pinnie), team switch, removed from a game, last call and organizer announcements.
- With the page open: an on-screen banner, a beep and a vibration.

Signing out

- Sign out takes your name off games that haven't started and frees your name for later.

Organizer features

Organizers sign in once and run every event from the same account.

Account and events

- Organizer account with a username and password; an optional sign-up code limits who can create organizer accounts.
- Your events: live events (code, players, games played), a New event button, and ended events below; a simple first-visit screen when you have none.
- The Next Up logo returns to your events from any organizer screen; the sign-in page links to joining as a player.

Creating an event

- New event page: event name plus a 4-digit code or custom password; settings fold into a summary that defaults to your last event's.
- Settings: players per team, game length, games at once, boards in the line (or no limit), sign-ups per person (or no limit), friends each player can add (no limit, a number, or off), which team gets pinnies, players pick their own team, players can take their name off, heads-up minutes before a game ends, and colors (6 schemes or your own).
- Change any setting mid-event from Settings; every phone updates when you save.

Sharing the event

- Big join code and QR code on the event screen, plus Share link.
- Make a new random code or set a custom password at any time; people already in stay in.

Running the line

- The line fills to the board count automatically; the game on the field doesn't count, and a fresh board appears when a game starts.
- Start a game, pause and resume, add or take away a minute, and end and clear it.
- Reorder waiting games, swap pinnies, add walk-up players by name, move players between teams and take them off a game.
- Clear board (fixed board count) empties a board but keeps it; Delete (unlimited line or last call) removes it for good.
- Last call stops new boards while the remaining games play out; Reopen the line undoes it, and you get a "That's a wrap" alert when the last game ends.

Players

- Players list showing who has alerts on, how many games each is on, and who is a walk-up or a friend of someone.
- Sign out a player's phone (frees the name, keeps their spots) or remove them from the event.
- Announce: send a message to everyone as a notification.

Your own alerts

- Turn your own alerts on or off; you're notified when a game's time is up.

Ending

- End event frees the code; the ended screen shows games played and players, with Back to all events and Start a new event.
- Reopen or delete an ended event under More options.

Testing already done

Every feature was tested as it was built, on the real Cloudflare runtime and in a browser on simulated iPhone and Android screens. What's left for the practice session is what only real phones, real notifications and a real field can show.

Area	Checked automatically	Still needs real phones
Push notifications	Encryption checked against the reference library; a notification delivered end to end to a test push service	Arrival on real iPhone and Android lock screens
Sign-up rules	Board count, sign-ups per person, no double sign-ups, full games, unique names, last call, clear board	Nothing extra
Live updates and timers	Changes reach connected screens instantly; the timer fires "time's up" and "you're on" with nobody tapping	Staying in sync across 10+ phones on mobile data

Area	Checked automatically	Still needs real phones
Joining	QR link, typed code, custom password, wrong code, "Is that you?" for friends, walk-ups and signed-in names, move codes	Scanning the QR with a phone camera; installing to an iPhone Home Screen
Friends	Adding, choosing and switching teams, owner-only changes, alerts sent to the adder, taking over a spot, limits	Nothing extra
Screens	Organizer home, New event page, settings, ended screen, colors in light and dark mode, confirmations that still work inside in-app browsers	Real phone sizes, and links opened inside Instagram or GroupMe

Run the automated tests again any time with `npm test` in the project folder; it takes about a minute and ends with "All checks passed".

Before you test

Run one practice session with at least 4 devices and a helper before a real night.

- **Devices:** the deployed site (https), 1 organizer phone, at least 3 player phones including one iPhone and one Android, and a laptop if you have one.
- **Test event:** name it something like "TEST practice" and delete it afterward.
- **Short timers:** set game length to 2 minutes and the heads-up to 1 minute so timer alerts arrive quickly.
- **Latest version:** run `npm run deploy` after your last code change, then refresh every phone.

Limits to plan around:

- iPhones only get alerts from the Home Screen app (iOS 16.4 or newer).
- Private or incognito windows block notifications entirely.
- Links opened inside apps like Instagram or GroupMe may not support alerts; players should open the link in Safari or Chrome.

- Cloudflare's free plan allows 100,000 requests a day, far more than one session of about 50 players uses.

Test checklist

Work through these in order at the practice session; each line is the action, then what you should see. Tick each one as it passes.

1. Organizer setup

- [ ] Create an organizer account → the "No events yet" screen appears.
- [ ] Sign out and sign back in → your events are still there.
- [ ] New event with only a name, then Start event → the event opens with a 4-digit code and a QR code.
- [ ] Back on your events → the event shows under Live now with its code.
- [ ] Open New event again → the settings say "Same as your last event".
- [ ] Create an event with a custom password → players can join with it in any capitalization.

2. Joining

- [ ] Scan the QR code with a phone camera → the name step opens with the event name shown.
- [ ] Type the code by hand on another phone → the name step appears.
- [ ] Enter a wrong code → "No live event with that code".
- [ ] On a second phone, join with a name already signed in → "Is that you?"; Yes signs in with the same spots and the first phone gets a heads-up; No asks for a different name.
- [ ] Scan the QR again on a phone that already joined → it goes straight back to its board.

3. Home Screen app and alerts

- [ ] iPhone in Safari → the bar says alerts need the Home Screen app, and Show me how gives steps that match your iOS.
- [ ] On iPhone, add to the Home Screen, open from the icon and enter a move code from the browser → same name and game spots, no new name needed.
- [ ] On Android, tap Add to Home Screen in the "Get it as an app first" card → the app installs.
- [ ] Tap Turn on → a "You're signed in as" notification arrives.

- [ ] Lock the phone, then the organizer starts that player's game → "Game N is on" appears on the lock screen.
- [ ] Tap Turn off, then reopen the app → alerts stay off and no notifications arrive.
- [ ] Organizer turns on their own alerts → a time's-up notification arrives when a game's timer ends.

4. Sign-ups and the line

- [ ] With 3 boards set → the line shows 3 empty boards before anyone signs up.
- [ ] Put your name down → it appears on every other screen within a couple of seconds.
- [ ] Try to sign up for the same game twice → refused.
- [ ] With 1 sign-up per person, try a second game → refused until your game is played.
- [ ] Fill a game → it shows Full and takes no more names.
- [ ] Start Game 1 → it moves to On the field, a new empty board appears, and the line still shows 3.
- [ ] Take your name off a waiting game → the spot opens on every screen.
- [ ] Turn on "Players pick their own team" → Join Team 1 and Join Team 2 buttons appear.

5. Timer and game control

- [ ] Start a 2-minute game → the timer counts down in sync on every phone.
- [ ] Pause, +1 min, −1 min, Resume → every phone shows the same time.
- [ ] Heads-up time reached → the next game's players get "Get ready".
- [ ] Timer reaches zero → "TIME'S UP" shows, the next game's players get "You're on!", and the organizer gets a time's-up alert.
- [ ] End & clear → the game moves to Recent games and the next game becomes up next.
- [ ] Swap pinnies → the pinnies badge moves on every screen.
- [ ] Reorder with ↑ or ↓ → up next changes and the new up-next players are notified.

6. Friends

- [ ] Add a friend to Team 2 → they show as "your friend" on Team 2; other players see "friend of" your name.
- [ ] Switch the friend's team, then take them off → works for you; other players get no buttons on that friend.
- [ ] The friend's game comes up → your phone gets "For <friend>: …".

- [ ] The friend joins on their own phone with that name → "Is that you?"; Yes gives them the spot, No asks for a different name.
- [ ] Organizer sets friends to Off → the Add a friend button disappears.

7. Organizer tools

- [ ] Add a walk-up name → it appears on the board and as a walk-up in Players.
- [ ] Move a player between teams, then take them off a game → that player is notified.
- [ ] Clear board on a board with names → the board stays, empty, and those players are notified.
- [ ] Announce a message → every player with alerts on receives it.
- [ ] Sign out a player's phone → that phone returns to the join screen and the name can be used again.
- [ ] New code → the old code stops working; players already in stay in.
- [ ] Change colors in Settings and Save → every phone changes.

8. Last call and ending

- [ ] Turn on Last call → players get a notice and see the banner; no new board appears when a game starts.
- [ ] Delete a board during last call → it is removed for good.
- [ ] Reopen the line → boards refill to the board count.
- [ ] Play the last game out → the organizer gets "That's a wrap".
- [ ] End event → the ended screen shows a recap, and the code no longer works for joining.
- [ ] Back to all events → the event is listed under Ended; Reopen under More options works.

9. Real-world conditions

- [ ] 10 or more phones joined at once → the board stays live with no noticeable lag.
- [ ] Turn on airplane mode for 30 seconds, then off → the board catches up on its own.
- [ ] Leave a phone asleep for 10 minutes, then open it → the board is current.
- [ ] Open the join link from inside Instagram or GroupMe → note whether alerts work; if not, tell players to open it in Safari or Chrome.
- [ ] A phone in dark mode → every screen is readable.
- [ ] After the session → delete the test events.